

5.2 Matter

This part of the module considers how kinetic theory explains the behaviour of matter in probabilistic and mechanical terms. The beginnings of the basis of thermodynamic thinking appear in the study of the Boltzmann factor.

The first section (**5.2.1**) explains ideal gas behaviour in terms of the kinetic theory.

The second section (**5.2.2**) introduces the Boltzmann factor as the link between energy and temperature. The important idea that differences drive change is introduced here.